Exercise: Peer Feedback Round

Type: Small-group discussion (pairs or groups of 3) **Time:** 10 minutes (2 min note-taking during the peer briefing + 3 min written feedback + 2 min exchange + 3 min group synthesis)

Objective

Exchange rubric-tied feedback with a peer on the capstone briefing each of you just delivered. Practice both sides of the feedback exchange: specific, actionable observation as the giver, and non-defensive hearing as the receiver. Both are skills that matter on the job, and the feedback round is the low-stakes place to practice them.

Scenario

You just delivered your five-minute OrbitCo capstone briefing in a small group of three or four. Every learner in your group watched every other learner's briefing. Now, each of you writes specific feedback for one assigned peer, and you exchange it in pairs. The feedback is tied to the four-dimension rubric used for the capstone — data handling, visualization, presentation, and communication — not to generic impressions.

Instructions

1. Receive the peer feedback form from the instructor, with the four rubric dimensions as column headers and space under each for specific observations.
2. During the assigned peer's briefing delivery, take written notes against the rubric in real time. Do not rely on memory — memory smooths out specifics, and specifics are the point.
3. After the briefing, spend 3 minutes writing the feedback. For each rubric dimension, write at least one concrete observation. The form should capture:
    - **Two things that worked.** Specific and tied to the rubric. Example: "Slide 3's sentence title named the finding directly — I knew the takeaway before you narrated it." Not "your intro was good."

- **One thing to change next time.** Specific and actionable. Example: "Slide 5 had three ideas on it — splitting it into two slides would have made each idea land harder." Not "too much content."
- **One follow-up question** you would have asked if you had been in a real audience, and a one-line note on how the presenter could have been prepared for it.

4. Exchange feedback in pairs, 2 minutes each direction. The listener thanks the giver and does not argue the feedback; if something is unclear, ask one clarifying question. Do not debate whether the feedback is "right."
5. In a brief group synthesis (3 min), each learner names one specific thing they will change about how they build their next briefing. The instructor captures patterns on the whiteboard.
6. Submit the completed feedback form to the instructor.

Example

A strong peer feedback form entry:

Dimension	What worked	What to change	Follow-up I would have asked
Data handling	"Slide 3 cited 413 tickets and 19 missing-severity flags — both traced back to the Lesson 1 lab numbers. Credibility was built early."	—	—
Visualization	"The week-4 callout on the trend chart was the clearest thing in the whole briefing. I knew exactly where to look."	"The severity donut on slide 4 had five slices but defaulted to Excel's palette — the Medium-severity slice blended into the legend background."	—
Presentation	"The Title Only layout for the recommendation slide worked. One sentence, large type, nothing else — the slide itself was the argument."	"Slide 5 (options) had the four options in four equal-sized boxes. The 'do nothing' option probably deserved a smaller box to signal that you had ruled it out."	—
Communication	"'I recommend refactoring the top-three runbooks and re-evaluating the hiring ask in 30 days' — one sentence, no hedging. Strongest moment in the briefing."	—	**Question:** "What is the latest you would wait before acting on the hiring ask, given the 22% volume trend?" **Prep:** the answer would be a projection slide in the appendix

Dimension	What worked	What to change	Follow-up I would have asked
			showing ticket volume forward 30 and 60 days.

A weaker entry (for contrast): "Your intro was good. Your deck looked nice. I would maybe add more visuals." None of that is actionable. The giver either did not watch closely or is avoiding specifics.

Expected Deliverables

- A completed peer feedback form per briefing, with at least one specific observation in each of the four rubric dimensions (six entries minimum: two things that worked, one thing to change, one follow-up question with a preparation note).
- A two-minute exchange conversation in pairs, with the listener thanking the giver without arguing.
- A one-sentence personal commitment from each learner in the group synthesis, captured on the whiteboard: "Next time I build a briefing, I will [specific change]."

Success Criteria

You have completed this exercise successfully when you can:

- Write feedback that a peer could act on without you explaining it further — the observation cites the specific slide, the specific moment, or the specific chart element.
- Receive feedback without defending, arguing, or interrupting. A clarifying question is allowed; a rebuttal is not.
- Distinguish between feedback tied to the rubric (actionable) and feedback tied to personal taste (not actionable), and keep your own feedback in the first category.
- Name one specific change you will make to your next briefing based on feedback you received — not a vague intention, a concrete change.
- Defend your written observations if challenged by the instructor, because they are grounded in what happened on the projector, not in generic impressions.